



YOU ARE PLAYING

Parker Brightwell

Mayor of Larkhaven

“Larkhaven’s mayor, and never more than a minute away from a speech.”

**FOR PARKER BRIGHTWELL’S EYES ONLY**

Do not share this booklet. Do not read ahead of the rounds.

COSTUME IDEA

A sash or ribbon across the chest, a smart suit or dress, and an oversized ceremonial key.

WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS ABOUT YOU

Mayor of Larkhaven for nine years. Parker leads the midnight countdown from the tower steps every year and has big plans for the town’s future.

- ◆ **Ellis Pendleworth:** an old friend and a frequent sparring partner on the town council
- ◆ **Devon Ashby:** the planner the town hired to run tonight’s gala
- ◆ **Emerson Quill:** the reporter who writes down every word you say

PAGE 2**Before the game**

Read before guests arrive

PAGE 3**Rounds 1 · 2**

Read each only when told

PAGE 4**Round 3 · Notes**

Suspects & your theories

Turn the page only when you are ready to begin. Detective Rowan Hale will tell you when to read each round.



Before the game



THE TRUTH

You are innocent. You did not harm Ellis. But you do have something to hide, so tonight you will look suspicious.

Your background

You have been mayor for nine years. You love Larkhaven, its river and its famous clock. The town hired Devon Ashby to run tonight's gala, and you signed off on every invoice.

YOUR SECRET

You want to move Old Lark's famous mechanism into a shiny new Town Hall museum and sell the old tower as flats. Ellis refused flatly. At 9:30 the two of you argued in the workshop, and you tore a page of your speech in half in a temper.

Your story tonight

You argued with Ellis briefly at 9:30, then went back to the front shop. From 10:00 to 10:25 you were at the toast rehearsal by the piano, and you squeezed into the photo booth with Reese Calloway and Harper Lune.

Your goals tonight

- ◆ Keep the museum plan quiet
- ◆ Make sure Old Lark still strikes midnight for the town
- ◆ Find out whether the town's money was handled honestly

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

- ◆ Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2; page 4 holds Round 3. Read each round **only when Detective Rowan Hale announces it**.
- ◆ Print this booklet **single-sided** so later rounds never show through. You can also cut along the dashed line on page 3 and hand out the rounds one at a time.
- ◆ Share what your round tells you to share. Everything on this page stays secret unless a round says otherwise.

Rounds 1 and 2



✦ Round 1



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 1.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Tonight is about Larkhaven! Remind everyone that Old Lark must still strike at midnight, whatever happens.
- ◆ You saw Ellis in the workshop at 9:30. Ellis was perfectly well, and very stubborn.
- ◆ The town paid for tonight's gala. You signed every invoice Devon Ashby sent you.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Harper Lune** how they can prove they are really Ellis's relative.
- ◆ Ask **Reese Calloway** how much they once offered Ellis for Old Lark's mechanism.

YOUR TASK

Give a short, rousing "Mayor's welcome" toast with cocoa or cider, and notice who whispers during it.

----- ✂ FOLD OR CUT HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE -----

✦ Round 2



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 2.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ If the torn speech page (E4) comes up, admit it is yours. You lost your temper at 9:30, nothing more.
- ◆ At about 8:45, Ellis asked you for five private minutes after the announcement: "About the gala accounts, Parker. You'll want to sit down."
- ◆ One of those invoices was for 400 fireworks. You never checked how many actually arrived.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** how many fireworks are waiting for midnight.
- ◆ Ask **Emerson Quill** what they plan to print in tomorrow's Ledger.

YOUR TASK

Find the letter from Ellis's desk (E8) and ask the group what it means for the town's money.

Round 3 and notes



✦ Round 3✦✦✦

Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 3.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ If pressed, admit the museum plan. You wanted Old Lark in a museum, not Ellis out of the way.
- ◆ From 10:00 to 10:25 you were at the toast rehearsal. The photo-booth strip (E9) shows you there at 10:12.
- ◆ Devon Ashby had promised to bring punch to the rehearsal at ten. It never came, and neither did Devon.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Avery Vale** whether Ellis ever skipped winding the mantel clock.
- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** to account for every minute between 10:00 and 10:25.

YOUR TASK

Before the ballots, give the room a one-minute “Mayor’s summary” of the case so far.

Notes

Suspects at a glance

Avery Vale · Apprentice Clockmaker	Parker Brightwell · Mayor of Larkhaven
Reese Calloway · Rival Watchmaker from the City	Emerson Quill · Reporter, The Larkhaven Ledger
Harper Lune · The Clockmaker’s Long-Lost Relative	Devon Ashby · Gala Party Planner
Kit Sterling · Antique Dealer	Sage Whitfield · Gala Pianist & Bandleader
Rory Penhallow · Keeper of the Clock Tower	Blair Okafor · Town Historian
Dakota Fenwick · Fireworks Master	Marley Ashgrove · Society Photographer